

FILM DOSSIER: BLACK PANTHER

Phase 3 · Film #2 (Saga Film #19)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	19 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #2)
Phase	Phase 3
Real title	<i>BLACK PANTHER</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"MOTHERLAND"</i>
Release date	Friday, July 8, 2016
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Ryan Coogler
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 158 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + royal succession drama / Afrofuturist epic

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	CHADWICK BOSEMAN. The Black Panther franchise is his.

Character	Actor	Age at release
T'Challa / Black Panther	Chadwick Boseman	39
N'Jadaka / Erik Killmonger	Michael B. Jordan	29
Nakia (of the Dora Milaje)	Lupita Nyong'o	33
Okoye (of the Dora Milaje)	Danai Gurira	38
Shuri	Letitia Wright	22
Queen Mother Ramonda	Angela Bassett	57
Zuri	Forest Whitaker	54
W'Kabi	Daniel Kaluuya	27
M'Baku / Man-Ape	Winston Duke	29
Ulysses Klaw	Andy Serkis	52
King T'Chaka (flashbacks)	John Kani	72
Reed Richards (cameo)	Pedro Pascal	41
Stan Lee (cameo: a man at a casino bar in Busan)	Stan Lee	93

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>"Panther's Rage"</i> , <i>Jungle Action</i> #6–18 (1973–75), Don McGregor & Billy Graham: Erik Killmonger leads a rebellion in Wakanda, throws T'Challa over Warrior Falls , and T'Challa comes back to fight for his throne. <i>Fantastic Four</i> #52–53 (1966), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby: T'Challa's debut, Klaw murdering King T'Chaka , Wakanda, vibranium.
Supporting comics	<i>Avengers</i> #62 (1969, M'Baku / Man-Ape) · <i>Black Panther</i> vol. 3 (1998–2003, Christopher Priest: the Dora Milaje, Okoye and Nakia) · <i>Black Panther</i> vol. 4 #2 (2005, Shuri) · <i>Jungle Action</i> #6 (1973, W'Kabi and Zuri)
Nerf check	✅ Killmonger beats T'Challa and throws him over Warrior Falls , exactly as in <i>Jungle Action</i> #6. T'Challa wins the rematch through will , not a sudden power-up.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96% . "Panther's Rage" is adapted with its structure intact, and <i>FF</i> #52–53 supplies the backstory.

Straight from the page:

- **Wakanda**: an isolated, hyper-advanced African nation built on the world's only **vibranium** mound (*FF* #52).
- **Klaw murdered King T'Chaka** when T'Challa was a boy. **Young T'Challa destroyed Klaw's right hand** (*FF* #53).
- **The Heart-Shaped Herb** gives the Black Panther his powers, and **the Panther God Bast** chooses the king (616).
- **Erik Killmonger, born N'Jadaka in Wakanda**, was exiled when Klaw took his family. He grew up in the U.S. and came back **to take the throne** (*Jungle Action* #6).
- **Killmonger throws T'Challa over Warrior Falls** (*Jungle Action* #6). **T'Challa survives, and returns** (#6–18).
- **W'Kabi**, T'Challa's security chief, **wavers in his loyalty** (*Jungle Action*).
- **The Dora Milaje**, the king's elite guard (Priest).
- **M'Baku** challenges T'Challa for the throne, and **becomes Man-Ape** (*Avengers* #62).
- **Shuri**, T'Challa's brilliant sister (vol. 4).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Nakia's 616 turn to villainy (as Malice) is held back | It's held for a sequel. She's loyal in this film. |

| Klaw's appearance is a cameo | He was the villain in *Ultron Unlimited*'s mid-credit scene, and this finishes his story |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Black Panther	The Heart-Shaped Herb: peak-human-plus strength, speed, agility, stamina and senses; genius scientist and strategist ; master of every fighting style ; vibranium habit (a suit that absorbs kinetic energy); king of the richest nation on Earth (<i>FF</i> #52)	All of it: outruns a speeding car on foot, climbs a sheer cliff, beats M'Baku in ritual combat, out-strategizes Killmonger in the final battle	His Avengers-level leadership (on 616 he's an Avenger from #52)	✓ 100%
Killmonger	Peak-human genius ; expert tactician, martial artist and marksman; later empowered by the Heart-Shaped Herb (<i>Jungle Action</i> #6)	Takes the herb and matches T'Challa physically	—	✓ 100%
Shuri	Genius scientist and inventor	Builds Wakanda's technology and T'Challa's new suit	Her own Panther mantle (616 later)	✓ 100%
The Dora Milaje	Elite warriors	Okoye's spear work	—	✓ 100%
M'Baku	Great strength; the White Gorilla cult	Ritual combat	—	✓ 100%
Klaw	A sonic weapon grafted to his wrist	A casino fight in Busan	—	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	The new king of the most advanced nation on Earth comes home to take his father's throne, and finds that a Wakandan exile with a claim of his own has come home first.
Theme	What does a king owe the world? Wakanda has hidden itself for centuries. Killmonger asks whether it had the right to.
Villain / antagonist	N'Jadaka / Erik Killmonger (main); Klaw ; M'Baku (a rival who becomes an ally)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE KING

- **Wakanda, Monday, April 25, 2016.** Two weeks after Civil War, **T'Challa** comes home to be crowned.

- **M'Baku** of the Jabari challenges him at Warrior Falls. T'Challa wins, and **saves him**.
- **Klaw** surfaces in **Busan**, selling stolen vibranium. T'Challa, **Nakia** and **Okoye** go after him in a casino and on a car chase through the city.
- Klaw's buyer shoots him and takes the vibranium. The buyer is **Erik Killmonger**.

ACT TWO: WARRIOR FALLS

- Killmonger arrives in Wakanda with **Klaw's body** as proof. **He's Wakandan**: born **N'Jadaka**, exiled as a child, and the son of a Wakandan the royal family abandoned.
- He demands **ritual combat for the throne**.
- **At Warrior Falls, Killmonger beats T'Challa and throws him over the falls**.
- **Killmonger becomes king**, takes the **Heart-Shaped Herb**, and orders that **Wakandan weapons be shipped to the world's oppressed**.
- **W'Kabi** backs him. Okoye stays loyal to the throne, whoever sits on it.

ACT THREE: PANTHER'S RAGE

- **M'Baku** has T'Challa's broken body, which the Jabari pulled out of the river.
- **Bast** speaks to T'Challa in the ancestral plane, and **his father** asks him: *"What will you do differently?"*
- T'Challa comes back. **Shuri** gives him a new suit.
- **The battle for Wakanda**: the Jabari, the Dora Milaje and **the whole nation divided**.
- **T'Challa vs. Killmonger** in the vibranium mines. **T'Challa wins**.
- Killmonger, dying, refuses to be healed: *"Bury me in the ocean with my ancestors who jumped from the ships."*
- **T'Challa takes Wakanda into the world**: an outreach center in Oakland, and a seat at the United Nations: *"Wakanda will no longer watch from the shadows."*

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, April 25, 2016 → Saturday, June 18, 2016.
Where it's set	Wakanda (Birnin Zana, Warrior Falls, the Jabari mountains, the vibranium mines) · Busan, South Korea · Oakland, California (filmed on location in South Africa, Uganda, Zambia's Victoria Falls, South Korea and Oakland)
Relative to other films	Two weeks after <i>Civil War</i> . T'Challa's side in that conflict is part of the political pressure on him at home.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Wakanda:** its tribes, its traditions, vibranium, the Heart-Shaped Herb, Bast, the ancestral plane.
- **The Dora Milaje, Shuri, M'Baku, W'Kabi, Ramonda.**
- **Wakanda goes public,** which changes the MCU's geopolitics.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Wakanda is open	The UN speech	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i>
The Fantastic Four	Reed Richards, who fought T'Challa years ago (616: <i>FF</i> #52), congratulates him on the crowning: " <i>No hard feelings about the jungle trap?</i> "	Future FF films
Vibranium on the market	Killmonger's shipments are only partly recovered	Phase 3

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Bast's warning	In the ancestral plane, Bast shows T'Challa a vision: half the stars in the sky going out at once. " <i>The Titan's gift. Be ready, my son.</i> "	The snap is coming, and Wakanda will be needed

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✅ " THE UNITED NATIONS. " T'Challa finishes his speech. A delegate scoffs: " <i>What can a nation of farmers offer the world?</i> " T'Challa and Okoye look at each other and smile.
Post-credit scene	✅ " THE SURFER. " A rooftop in New York at night. The Silver Surfer , trapped on Earth, feels something in the cosmos shift . He clutches his head and cries out: " <i>The Gauntlet... he's going to use it.</i> " On the next roof over, Doctor Stephen Strange watches him, with his cloak moving in the windless air. CUT TO BLACK. " BLACK PANTHER WILL RETURN. "
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " GENERAL ASSEMBLY. " Post-credit: " ROOFTOP. "

CHECKLIST

- ☒ Comic(s) adapted · ☒ Comic Accuracy Report + powers · ☒ Real and decoy titles · ☒ What it's about · ☒ Villain · ☒ Post-credit scenes · ☒ The film's own world-building · ☒ MCU world-building · ☒ Big Bad setup · ☒ Whose franchise · ☒ When and where in the timeline